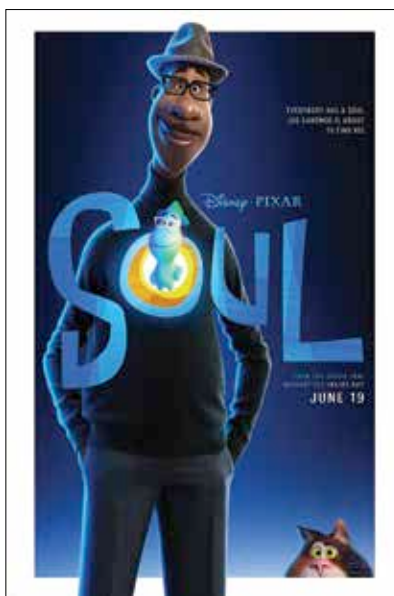


MOVIE

Soul

If there is one movie that you have to watch this year, try and make it Soul.

Pixar's latest animated feature is nothing short of an incredible journey through life, love and magic of music. Pixar have not yet disappointed when it comes to their films and Soul is no different. The film starts off with Joe, an aspiring jazz musician who wants nothing more in life than to make it in the jazz world. But, he's stuck teaching music to kids and really wants out of that life. He's got a mother who wants him to get a stable job and a last-minute gig that could change his fortunes. But, alas, after his incredible audition, he actually slips and falls into an open manhole and dies! Yep, the main character in this film kicks the bucket 10 minutes in! Of course, the



story doesn't end there as Joe's soul makes its way to the Great Beyond. While trying to escape purgatory to get back to the ultimate gig, he meets a wayward soul called 22 who must find her 'spark' before being incar-

nated on Earth. This is where Soul truly begins.

Directed by Pete Docter, Soul stars Jamie Foxx as Joe the jazz musician and Tina Fey as the wayward 22. We will not give away any more of the plot as the second half of this film is something you have to experience for yourself. Soul is unlike any other Pixar movie in that it is unabashedly weird. I mean, we are talking about an imagined afterlife! But being weird is not a bad thing, in fact it allows us to see things from a different perspective. We look at life through the lens of a middle-aged man trying to fulfil his dreams. We may think of animated films as children's fare, but what children's film has put us in the shoes of a slightly pudgy, middle-aged jazz musician, apart from the equally fantastic UP, which was also directed by Pete Docter.

Even the music is absolutely incredible with just the right emotional beats and flourishes. Trent Reznor and Atticus Ross have really knocked it out of the park with this one.

COMIC

Star Wars Adventures

★★★★☆ | The Star Wars comics of late are getting really good at adding additional details and answering questions about different points in time, that actually must have had a lot going on if you think about it. For example, the Star Wars comics started off earlier in the year exploring what happened in the crucial time just after Han Solo is frozen in carbonite and Luke finds out who his father is. Last year's Vader comic answers the question of where exactly Anakin Skywalker came from, and fleshes out Vader's tortured existence even at the height of his powers. Then we have the Bounty Hunters series that gives us the Boba Fett backstory we always wanted, and features everyone's favorite Trandoshan, Bossk. In all these comics the



artwork and storytelling is so great that you know already when picking up a Star Wars comic that you are going to be plonked right into the middle of a story that you are already familiar with, sometimes even overlapping with scenes from the movies. That is exactly what you get with Star Wars

Adventures, an anthology series that was originally slated for publishing in May this year but got delayed because of the pandemic.

Each issue of the anthology series contains two stories, and they can be from any era. The first issue for example has a story about Poe and Finn setting up the obstacle course for Rey to train on, and Rey running into some unexpected trouble on the way. The second part is a showcase of exactly the kind of thing we love about the Star Wars comics... it shows a sequence that we already see in the movies, the rebels, along with Han, Leia and Luke escaping Vader's assault on Echo base. There are even some panels that tie in to scenes deleted from The Empire Strikes Back! That is just the first issue, and there is a new issue every month. Additionally, we are not exactly sure what is going on here, but there seems to be spin off Star Wars Adventures issues as well, including Star Wars Adventures: Smuggler's Run and Star Wars Adventures: Destroyer Down.